

University Hospitals Bristol & Weston NHS Foundation Trust

NHS Audiology and Hearing Aids

Simon Collins

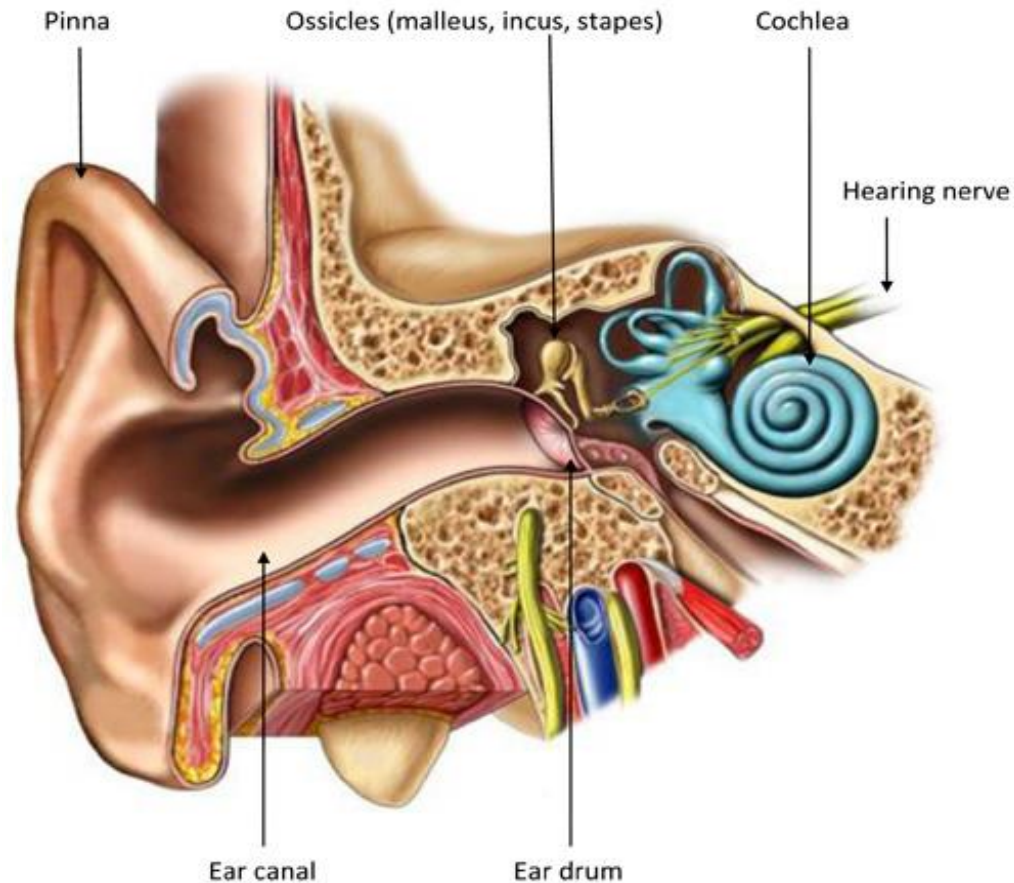
Who am I?

- Senior audiologist
- Worked at UHBW since 2017
- Congenital bilateral hearing loss
- Hearing aid user for 25 years

Aims

- What is hearing loss?
- Hearing aids (parts, Bluetooth/loop button)
- GP referrals to audiology
- Why/when/what to contact audiology for
- Audiology departments: locations, best way to contact

How do we hear?



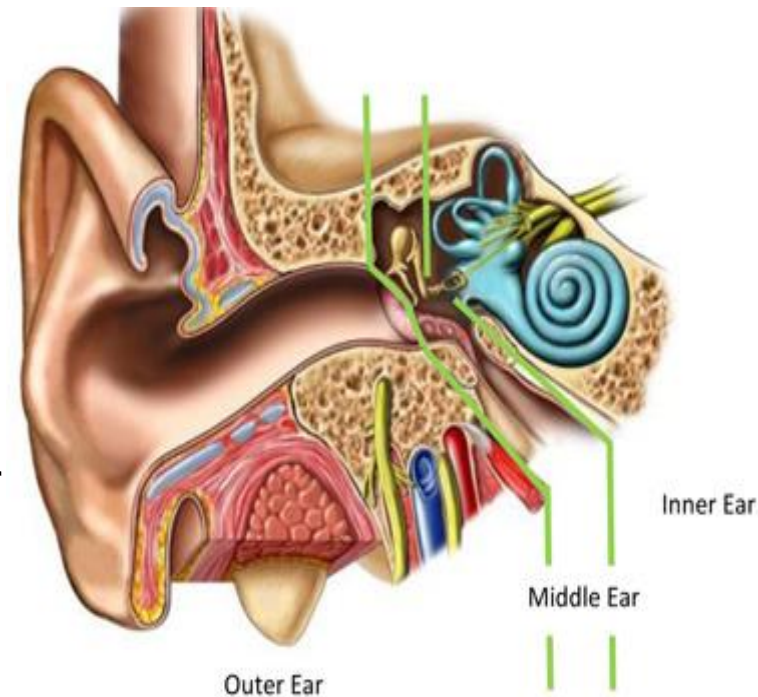
Types of Hearing Loss

Sensorineural hearing loss

- Caused by damage to the sensitive hair cells inside the inner ear, or damage to the auditory nerve
- Commonly seen as '**age-related**' hearing loss

Conductive hearing loss

- Sounds are unable to pass from the outer ear to the inner ear
- Can be caused by a **blockage** inside the middle ear



Diseases & Conditions

- Mumps
- Measles
- Rubella
- Paget's Disease
- Usher's Syndrome
- Acoustic Neuroma
- Carcinoma
- Neurofibromatosis
- RTA - fractures in the skull
- Bell's Palsy
- Otitis Externa
- Otitis Media
- Otosclerosis
- Eustachian Tube Dysfunction
- Meniere's Disease
- Presbycusis (age related 75% in >70s)
- Hyperacusis (sensitivity)
- Down's Syndrome
- OAD (obscure auditory dysfunction)
- Meningitis

Types of Hearing Loss

Mild

- Difficulty hearing speech in more difficult hearing environments

Moderate

- Difficulty hearing speech when not facing, or speaking loudly and clearly

Severe

- Difficulty hearing a lot unless lip-reading, or focusing hard

Profound

- Most sounds unable to be heard, speech unintelligible, aid required

Hearing Aids



BTE - 'behind the ear' hearing aids which are the most common type of hearing aid

They are normally held in the ear by an earmould or thintube and dome



ITE - 'in the ear' hearing aids that are small enough to sit in the ear

ITC - 'in the canal' hearing aids which sit farther into the ear



Body worn hearing aids - not as common as other hearing aids, and are more often worn by very elderly or dementia patients with a profound hearing loss

They have a microphone and ear receivers that are quite far apart, so there is less chance of feedback

Hearing Aids

A typical bone conduction aid



Bone Conducting Aid

This may be given to patients who have a conductive deafness

They do not sit on the ear but behind on the bone



BAHA (Bone Anchored Hearing Aid)

A metal stud is surgically implanted into the mastoid bone to which a bone-conductor is attached to convert sound into vibration



Cochlear Implant

A device which is surgically implanted into the cochlea that destroys the ear but supplants the sounds normally heard with electrical stimulation of the cochlea

An external processor also needs to be worn to function

Implanted from 5-6 months old up to 90+ years old

Our Current Hearing Aid

Bolero M70-M
Nadia M-70 SP
Naida P-70 UP



Thintubes



Open Dome Large 10mm



Open Dome Medium 8mm



Open Dome Small 6mm



Vented Dome Large 10mm



Vented Dome Medium 8mm



Vented Dome Small 6mm



Power Dome Large 10mm



Power Dome Medium 8mm



Power Dome Small 6mm



Cap Dome

Earmoulds



Loop (via programme button)

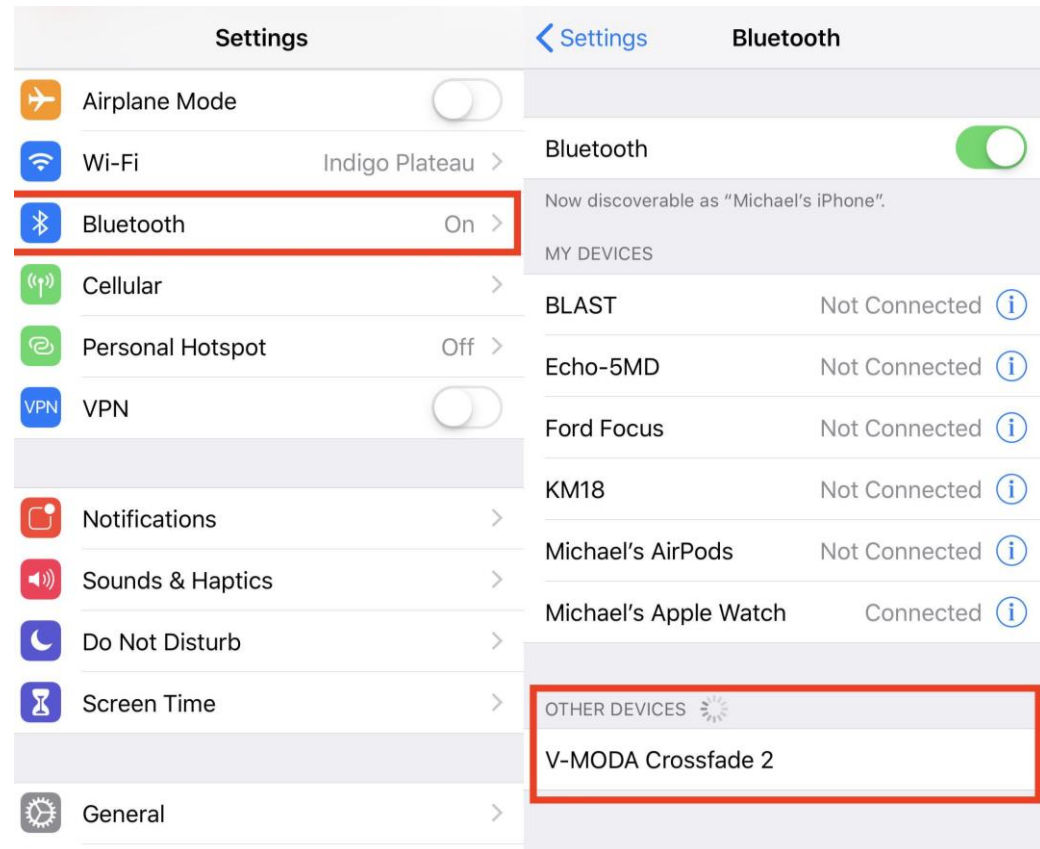


Bluetooth

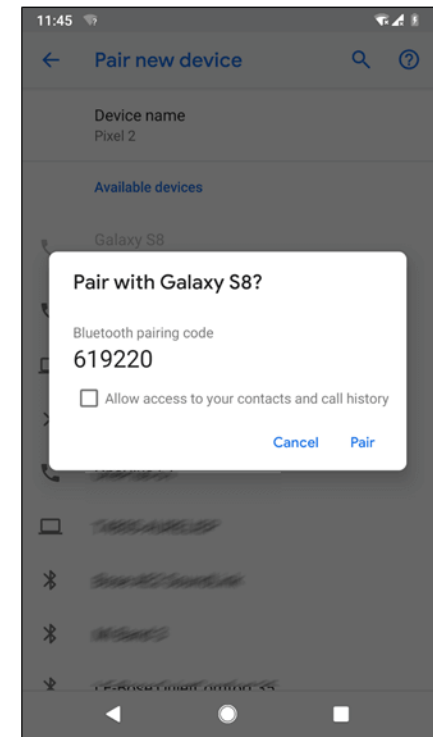
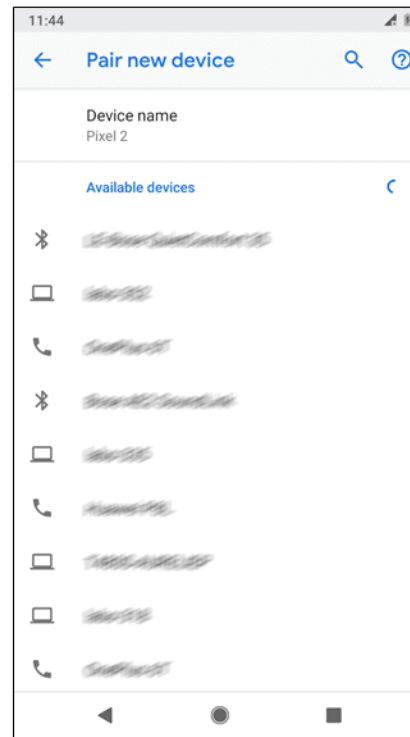
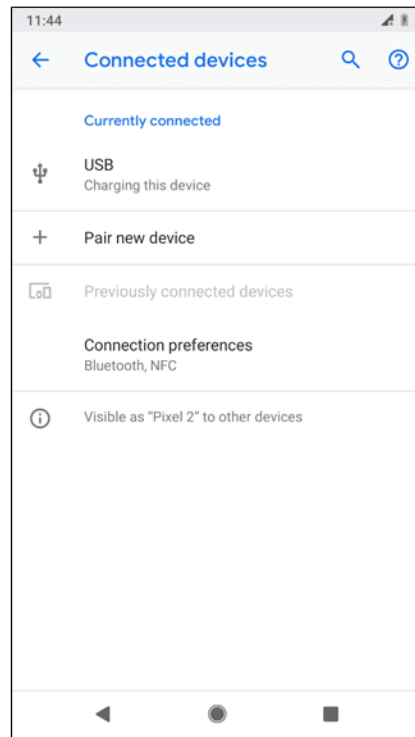
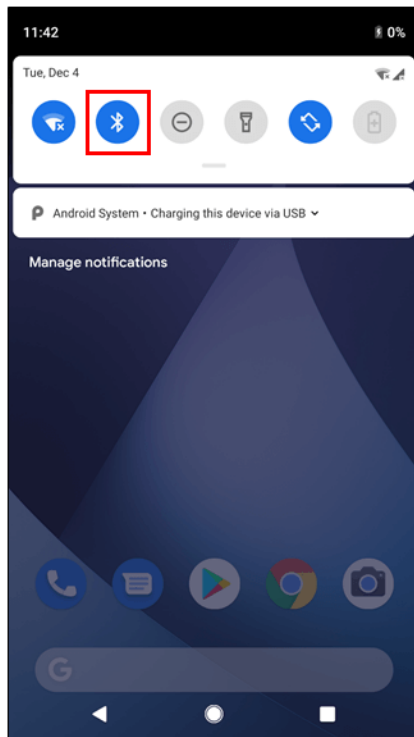


Bluetooth - Apple

- iPhone
- iPad
- iPod



Bluetooth - Android



Referrals to NHS Audiology

GP

- Will look in your ears, ask about hearing + other symptoms
- Tuning fork test, or whisper test
- May not ask where you'd like to go for a hearing test

ENT

- NHS and private ENT can refer to audiology
- Tinnitus, balance, hearing aids



Locations

- St Michael's Hospital
- Southmead Hospital
- Weston-Super-Mare General Hospital
- Cossham Hospital
- Thornbury
- Portishead
- Clevedon Hospital
- Stockwood
- South Bristol Community Hospital
- Domiciliary visits



Contacting Audiology

- **Hearing deterioration** - 3 years
- Broken/**lost** hearing aid – AQP
- **Maintenance** - 6-9 months
- Alterations to hearing aids (sound, comfort etc.)



Contacting Audiology

Email –

Audiology.Dept@uhbw.nhs.uk

Telephone –

0117 342 5854

Post -

Adult Audiology
St Michael's Hospital
St Michael's Hill
Bristol
BS2 8EG



Adult Audiology
Gate 36, Brunel Building
Southmead Hospital
Bristol
BS10 5NB

Hearing Aid Maintenance

Knowing how to keep a hearing aid working could be the difference between comfortable hearing and social isolation

Maintenance includes:

- Changing the batteries
- Keeping the earmoulds clear
- Retubing earmoulds
- Replacing thintubes

[http://www.uhbristol.nhs.uk/patients-and-visitors/your-hospitals/st-michaels-hospital/what-we-do/audiology/instructional-videos/How to retube your earmould](http://www.uhbristol.nhs.uk/patients-and-visitors/your-hospitals/st-michaels-hospital/what-we-do/audiology/instructional-videos/How-to-retube-your-earmould)